



May 2026



Presented by the
Community Foundation of Sarasota County

GIVING CHALLENGE RESULTS!

Thank you to the many generous Friends of the Park that donated during the Community Foundation of Sarasota County's Giving Challenge, as well as The Patterson Foundation for matching our wonderful supporters' donations. This year's results mark an all-time high! Every donation is crucial to help ensure that Manatee County's only botanical gardens remain free to the public 365 days per year and we continue to foster environmental education through school field trips, classes, and wonderful community events. All of these unrestricted proceeds will support our ongoing operations. We are truly so humbled and appreciative of your continued support!

Palma Sola Botanical Park Final Results!

159 Donors

\$15,290 Raised

\$12,690 Matched

\$27,980 Total!

Thank you cards are on the way soon and you can also see everyone that donated if you go to our Giving Challenge page (click link below)!

<https://www.givingchallenge.org/organizations/palma-sola-botanical-park-foundation-inc>





Total results from both Manatee & Sarasota counties!

Thank you for helping our garden grow!



BRADENTON'S BEST

— P E O P L E ' S C H O I C E —

ONE MORE WEEK TO PLEASE KEEP VOTING...

Palma Sola Botanical Park won Bradenton Herald's People's Choice award for Best Attraction in Manatee County in 2023 (Bronze) and in 2024 (Silver). Please help us make it a trifecta with a Gold in 2026! **Please click on the link below daily until May 8th!**

2026 Bradenton's Best

We are in two categories:
"Things to Do" then "Attraction"
"Services" then "Wedding Venue"



RIITFERFI Y DI ANTS

BOTANICAL PLANTS



HERBS
FLOWERS



PALMA SOLA
**Botanical
Park**
FOUNDATION, INC

BUY ONE GET ONE FREE SALE!

9am-12pm SAT. MAY 2, 2026

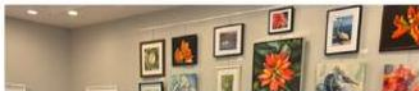
**HIDDEN GARDEN
NURSERY at Palma
Sola Botanical Park**

BOGO PLANTS:

**Cosmos
Red Begonias
White Begonias
Pothos
Crotons
Blazing Star
Calibrachloa
Herbs
Ground Orchids**



9800 17th Ave. NW Bradenton (next to Robinson Preserve)





GARDEN PARTY RECAP

Our Garden Party to benefit Palma Sola Botanical Park was a beautiful evening to remember under the stars! Thank you to everyone that attended(our largest crowd yet),

our always generous Event Sponsors, amazing Events Committee, wonderful adult and high school volunteers, charitable silent auction donors, always delicious Innovative Dining (enRich), fantastic Manatee River/Sycamore Shade Bluegrass Band, and everyone

else that helped make the night come together seamlessly. we are so appreciative of our village!

Good. Beautiful

Garden Party!

Evening Under the Stars

TO BENEFIT THE PALMA SOLA BOTANICAL PARK!



Event Sponsors

Red Silk Cotton Level

PULLEN
INVESTMENT MANAGEMENT

Sharon & Tommy
Howze

Royal Poinciana Level



Silk Floss Level



Sandra Robinson

Tom Brown & Karla Hager

Barney Hass & Jeanne Cowan

Royal Palm Level

Ed Kennedy & Nancy Reed ~ In Memory of Bob Christopher by Margaret Christopher
Parker Family Dental ~ Gail Hannah ~ Kitty Kole ~ Pat Van Court ~ David & Marion Perez
Becky Tolerton ~ John & Nancy Flynn ~ Publix ~ Breadsmith

Thank you for your continued support to help our garden grow!





DR. GERALDSON COMMUNITY GARDEN

GRAND OPENING!
10am-Noon
Sat. May 30th, 2026
1401 99th St NW Bradenton
(Next to Palma Sola Botanical Park)

You are invited to the Patricia and Dr. Carroll Geraldson Community Garden ribbon cutting ceremony with Manatee County Commissioners Tal Siddique and Amanda Ballard. This exciting new space is dedicated to growing produce, fostering community connections, and providing hands-on learning opportunities for all. This event will include a community garden tour, opportunity to meet our Community Garden Program Specialists, see the newly painted mural, as well as seed giveaways and children's crafts from Palma Sola Botanical Park and Hope Seeds. This is a free, family-friendly event is open to the public. No RSVP needed.



GRANT RECEIVED!

We are excited to announce that Palma Sola Botanical Park recently received a grant from the William G. & Marie Selby Foundation! The grant will be used to replace aged

venue rental furniture (tables, chairs, children's chairs, cocktail tables, & chair stands), as well as adding commercial grade aluminum plant tables to our Hidden Garden Nursery.

We are so thankful and appreciate of this much needed support!





PIC•COLLAGE



MCF BREAKFAST CLUB RECAP

We were honored to host the Manatee Community Foundation's April Breakfast Club. This is a chance to introduce new potential donors to our wonderful gardens and showcase all of the amazing benefits that we provide to the community. While our guests dined on breakfast on our deck overlooking the gardens, we spoke about the history of the park, all of our wonderful current programs, our lofty vision for the future, then ended with a tour of the beautiful grounds. We'd like to extend a huge thank you to the Manatee Community Foundation and donors for all that they do to support non-profits in Manatee County!



**MASTER
GARDENER**
UF | UNIVERSITY of
FLORIDA
IFAS Extension

2026 HORTICULTURAL CLASSES

The University of Florida/IFAS Manatee County Extension have partnered with us to offer classes at the Palma Sola Botanical Park. Join us to hear Horticultural Agent & Florida-Friendly Landscaping™ Program Coordinator Susan Griffith, as well as knowledgeable Manatee County Master Gardeners, for slideshow lectures about the latest topics affecting Manatee County. Sign up online through EventBrite (link below), stop by the park, or call 941-761-2866 to reserve your spot.



**Florida-Friendly Landscaping™:
Gardening for Pollinators
11am Thursday
May 28, 2026**

Pollinators come in many forms and all of them face many challenges in our modern world. For numerous reasons their numbers have been dropping drastically in the last several decades. Join us to discover how to create vibrant, pollinator-friendly habitats that give bees, butterflies, and other pollinators a sanctuary with the resources they need to flourish

[Florida-Friendly Gardening for Pollinators Tickets, Thursday, May 28 • 11 AM - 12:30 PM](#)
[| Eventbrite](#)

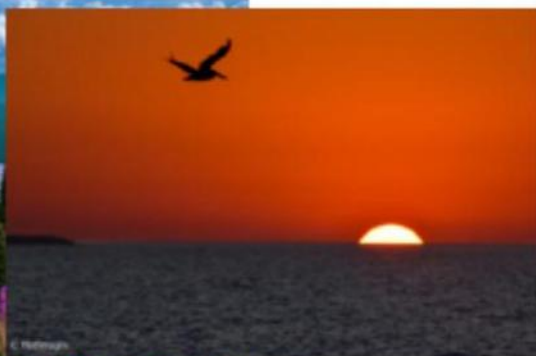
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|---|----------------------|--|
| May 28, 2026 | 11am Thursday | Florida-Friendly Gardening for Pollinators |
| Join us to discover how to create vibrant, pollinator-friendly habitats for bees, butterflies, and other pollinators. | | |
| June 25, 2026 | 11am Thursday | Planting, Establishing & Maintaining Landscape Plants |
| Join us to learn how to plant, nurture, and care for your new plants with confidence! | | |
| July 23, 2026 | 11am Thursday | Poisonous Plants |
| We'll explore everything from the mildly toxic varieties to the 6 highly dangerous plants you need to watch out for! | | |
| Aug. 20, 2026 | 11am Thursday | Heat Tolerant Plants |
| Discover the toughest, most resilient plants that can thrive in Florida's extreme heat! | | |
| Sept. 24, 2026 | 11am Thursday | Salt Tolerant Plants for Coastal Landscapes |
| Learn which plants can withstand anything from salty breezes and sandy soils to saltwater inundation. | | |

Oct. 22, 2026 11am Thursday **Backyard Landscaping for Wildlife**
Create a haven for birds, bats, butterflies and others in need of a neighborhood sanctuary.

Nov. 19, 2026 11am Thursday **Cold Weather Plant Preparedness**
Learn how to effectively prepare your plants to withstand freezing winter temperatures.

ART IN THE PARK

MADI WILKINSON, our **May** featured Artist of the Month, is a photographer focusing on wildlife and nature. All of the stunning photographs are for sale & a portion helps support Palma Sola Botanical Park!



Palma Sola Botanical Park ~ 9800 17TH Ave. NW Bradenton
Free Admission. Public welcome.



PIC•COLLAGE

Come check out our the gorgeous hand-carved sculptures currently on display in our gardens by Ennye Gallery. They are all for sale and a portion supports Palma Sola Botanical Park!



ARBOR DAY RECAP

Our favorite holiday! To celebrate his year, we planted a bridal veil tree (Caesalpinia granadillo) in the gardens near our wedding ceremony area thanks to a grant from the Florida Forest Management Bureau. This medium size tree with finely textured pinnately compound leaves resembles a bridal veil, giving the tree its name. Thank you to our hardworking Bright Futures high school volunteers for digging the hole!



May 19, 2026

**9am-Noon. Public & all ability levels welcome.
We'll supply the tools, water, snacks, & fresh air!**

9800 17th Ave. Bradenton. 941-761-2866

PIC-COLLAGE



STACY TATTAR

~ May ~

Stacy, a snowbird from Connecticut, is a new volunteer that jumped in with such enthusiasm. She came to our Garden Workdays and other days to weed, deadhead

geraniums, install littoral plants at the ponds, and more. She fell in love with the park and the other volunteers calling it "her therapy". We get it, our gardens are special! Thank you for all of your help and we hope to see you every winter!

"Many hands make light work."



WE HAVE THE BEST VOLUNTEERS!

Thank you to the many phenomenal volunteers that make Palma Sola Botanical Park so special. As you may or may not know, we have 1.5 paid office staff ~ Executive Director Beverly Burdette & part time Office Manager Jenny Gunter. The gardens are maintained by over 250 amazing volunteers (75+ high school Bright Futures students). We obviously couldn't do it without them and are so appreciative of all of their hard work! We show our appreciation with spring and fall Volunteer Appreciation Luncheons, as well as highlight Volunteers of the Month, Student Spotlights, and Volunteers of the Year awards. If you would like to volunteer, there are a variety of opportunities for all ages, ability levels, and interests. Please visit our website for more details. <https://palmasolabp.org/volunteer/>



VOLUNTEERS OF THE YEAR!

Board of Director - Barney Hass (right)

Franky McArthur (top left)

Randy (bottom left)

Congratulations to our 2026 Volunteers of the year! On top of his generous financial

support, Barney has been invaluable with his input on the Board, his dedication to always supporting events (he gathered 4 tables of 8 for this year's Garden Party), helping maintain the grounds, and more. Franky and Randy have been doing a phenomenal job growing our Bright Futures high school volunteering program on Wednesdays. They mentor, teach, and provide a fun space for students to learn more about nature while getting their college service hours. Franky and Randy have successfully written two grants to fund littoral plantings around our ponds that the students have been planting each week. Barney, his wife Jeanne Cowan (far right), Franky, and Randy are also instrumental in hanging millions of holiday lights in the gardens for our Winter Nights Under the Lights event in December. An honor so well deserved!





FLORA ~ WHAT'S BLOOMING?

The beautiful images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.





FEATHERED FRIENDS ~ RECENTLY SPOTTED!

The beautiful images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.





FAUNA ~ RECENTLY SPOTTED!

The beautiful images are courtesy of wildlife photographer Helen Lewis.

UF | IFAS Extension
UNIVERSITY of FLORIDA

JOIN US FOR
Demo Gardens Showcase

WEDNESDAY



May
20

9:00am-11:45am

1303 17th Street West,
Palmetto, FL 34221



Join our Master Gardeners for an immersive tour of our demonstration gardens. This educational opportunity covers a diverse range of landscaping options, including shade-loving plants, pollinator havens, bromeliads, roses, and wetlands, as well as native species, wildflowers, fruit trees, and vegetables. Designed for attendees ages 13 and up, the event pairs expert-led demonstrations with light refreshments.

Register here: <https://shorturl.at/FMOve>



An Equal Opportunity Institution.

YOGA in the **PARK**

Enjoy yoga here at the park in our beautiful, relaxing setting. Plus, a portion of the proceeds support the Park!

MONDAYS 4-5pm with *Angela Simone*
Basic Hatha Yoga/Alignment/All Levels
Call 941-704-8953 or walk-ins welcome.

TUESDAYS 6-7pm with *Laura Bennett* – *She's Back!*
Yoga/Pilates/Weights

Call 941-758-1741 to reserve your spot.

WEDNESDAYS 9-10am with *Angela Simone*
Basic Hatha Yoga/Alignment/All Levels
Call 941-704-8953 or walk-ins welcome.

Please contact the instructors directly with any questions, prices, and to reserve your spot.

Our new Zumba class begins June 1st!

FUN MUSIC GOOD VIBES PURE JOY

JOIN THE PARTY!

 **ZUMBA** [®] **FITNESS**

DANCE. SWEAT. SMILE.

All levels welcome!





MONDAYS
9:30AM



PALMA SOLA BOTANICAL PARK
Galleria Building
(Indoors & Air Conditioned)
9800 17th Ave NW
Bradenton, FL 34209

DROP-IN	MOST POPULAR!	BEST VALUE!	
5 CLASS PASS	10 CLASS PASS	FIRST CLASS	
\$15	\$80	\$100	\$5

\$15	\$60	\$100	\$5
Pay as you go	\$12/class Use within 90 days	\$10/class Use within 90 days	New clients only One-time intro offer

♥ Most clients choose a class pass for the best value!

just keep dancing!

♥

QUESTIONS / RESERVE YOUR SPOT

📞 941.301.8640

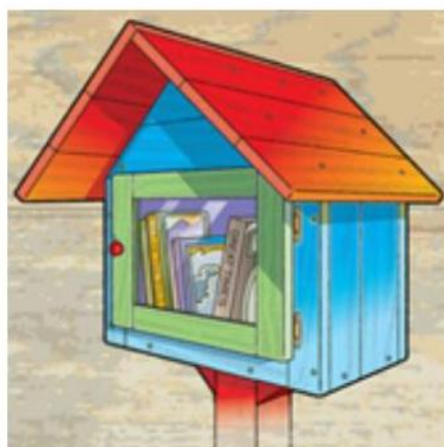
✉ ginarogerszumba@gmail.com

📷 @gingerzumba

🌐 ginam.zumba.com

PLUS, A PORTION OF THE PROCEEDS SUPPORT THE PARK!

BRING
WATER &
A TOWEL



BOOKS NEEDED

We are in need of used book donations for all ages to fill our two Free Little Libraries built by Eagle Scout Charlie Landers and the Manatee High Key Club. You can place donations directly into the libraries or drop off extras to our office. Thank you and Happy Reading!



Please consider supporting the park by becoming a member or renewing your membership. An annual gift of membership supports the ongoing sustainability and enhancement of the gardens. There are several levels for all budgets that come with perks including reciprocal membership to botanical parks across the country. Memberships begin anytime and are valid for 1 year from the start date.



AMERICAN HORTICULTURAL SOCIETY
**RECIPROCAL
GARDEN NETWORK**
member garden

[Reciprocal Admissions Program – American Horticultural Society \(ahsgardening.org\)](http://ahsgardening.org)

Join Here ~ MEMBERSHIP





OUR STORY

In 1990, the grassroots initiative for a botanical park began when local citizens and community groups rallied to save the 10 acre site from development that had previously served as the Manatee County Nursery. In 1993, the non-profit 501(c)(3) Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc. was established and the park has evolved ever since. The park does not charge an entrance fee and receives no federal, state, or local government subsidies. We rely greatly on donations to keep the park open free of charge to the public 7 days per week.

HOURS

Park Hours:

8am~Dusk Every Day

Please note that we close earlier due to the time change!

Office Hours:

8am~5pm Mon.-Fri.

ALWAYS FREE ADMISSION!

STAFF

Beverly Z. Burdette, Executive Director
bev@palmasolabp.org (New email!)

Jennifer Gunter, Office Manager/Venue Rentals

info@palmasolabp.org (New email!)

BOARD OF DIRECTORS

President - Kristin Mead, Retired Boyd Insurance

Vice President - Tyler Pullen, Pullen Investment Management

Treasurer - Michael Jaster, Manatee Rare Fruit Council

Secretary - Aedan Stockdale, Man. Co. Natural Resources

Josh Beyer, Civil Engineer

Barney Hass, Retired Realtor

Jack Hawkins, Retired Attorney

Richard Larsen, Florida Division of Forestry

John Lowenberg, Retired Fundraiser

Emeritus - Nick Baden, Retired Attorney

Ex-Officio - Beverly Burdette, Florida Landscape Architect

CONTACT INFORMATION

Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc.

Park Address:

[9800 17th Avenue Northwest](#)

[Bradenton, Florida 34209](#)

Mailing Address:

P.O. Box 14214

Bradenton, Florida 34280

(941) 761-2866

info@palmasolabp.org

www.palmasolabp.org



Our mission is to serve as a unique community resource dedicated to providing an interactive learning environment that fosters an appreciation of nature and landscaping, preserves our natural resources and promotes environmental education.

The Palma Sola Botanical Park Foundation, Inc. is a 501(c)(3) non-profit organization. Contributions are normally tax deductible under current IRS codes.



DONATE HERE

Manatee Rare Fruit Council

